

Master AI by Solving Job Bottlenecks

A proposed Board model built around real work, voluntary SIGs, and the loop:

LEARN → APPLY → TEACH BACK

BOARD DISCUSSION

**How do we turn daily work
problems into AI mastery—
and AILA thought
leadership?**

The member question is not “Which course should I take?”

It is:

“What do I need AI to help me do now?”

That reframes learning around a real goal, a real bottleneck, and an immediate reason to apply the skill.

Role

Goal

Bottleneck

AI help

Personal relevance becomes the entry point to mastery.



Passive AI learning is easy to consume—and easy to lose

1 Course-first

- Learn concepts in isolation
- Complete a module
- Return to work later
- Hope the knowledge transfers

2 Problem-first

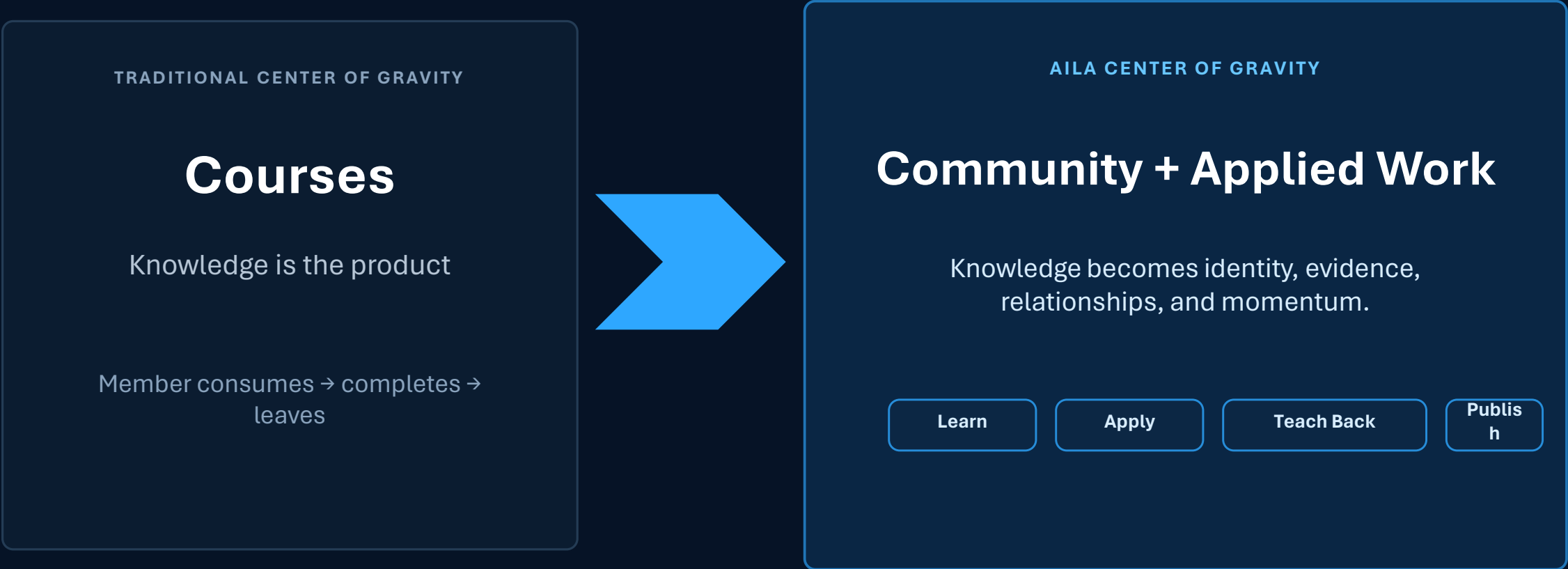
- Bring a real bottleneck
- Pull in the needed skill
- Apply it immediately
- Capture what actually worked

3 Community-first

- Teach back the result
- Get peer critique
- Improve the practice
- Turn experience into shared knowledge

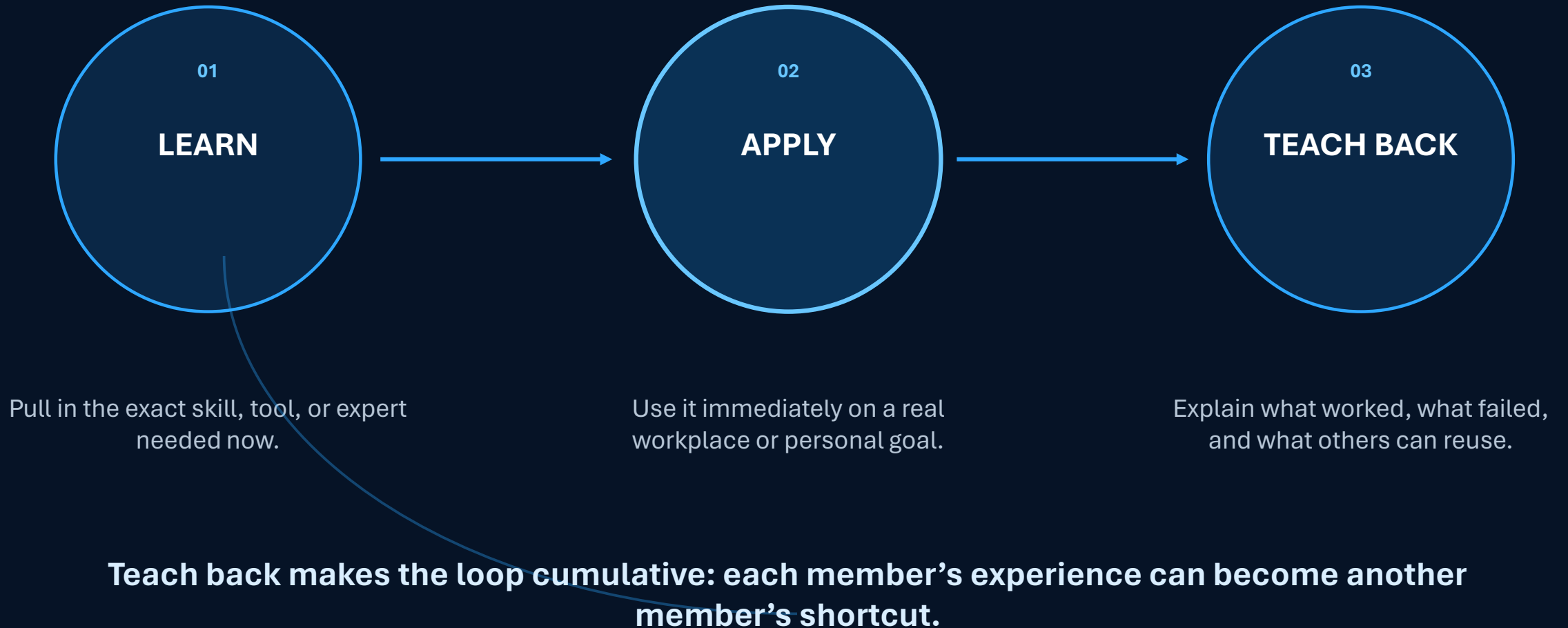
The shift is from “learning about AI” to “learning by changing real work.”

AILA’s strategic shift: from learning provider to progress ecosystem

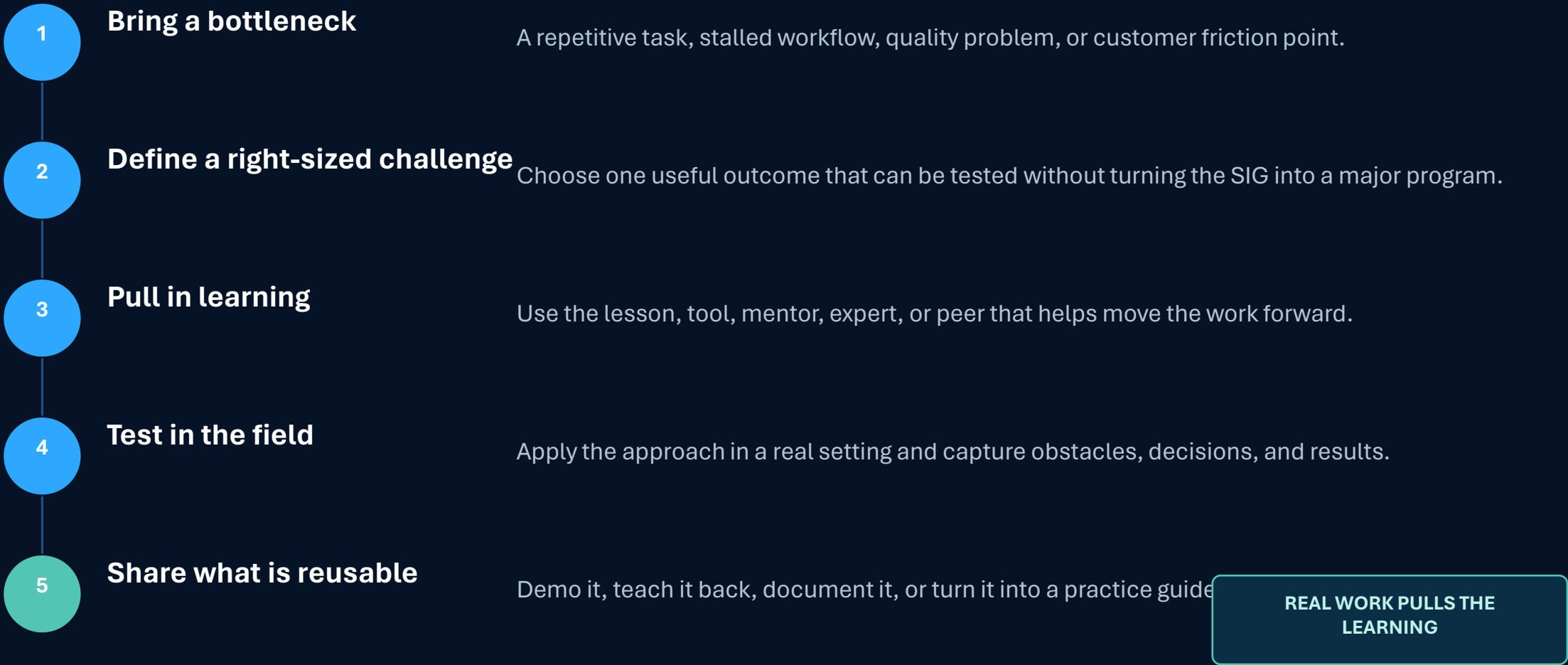


Courses remain important. They become one part of a larger value system.

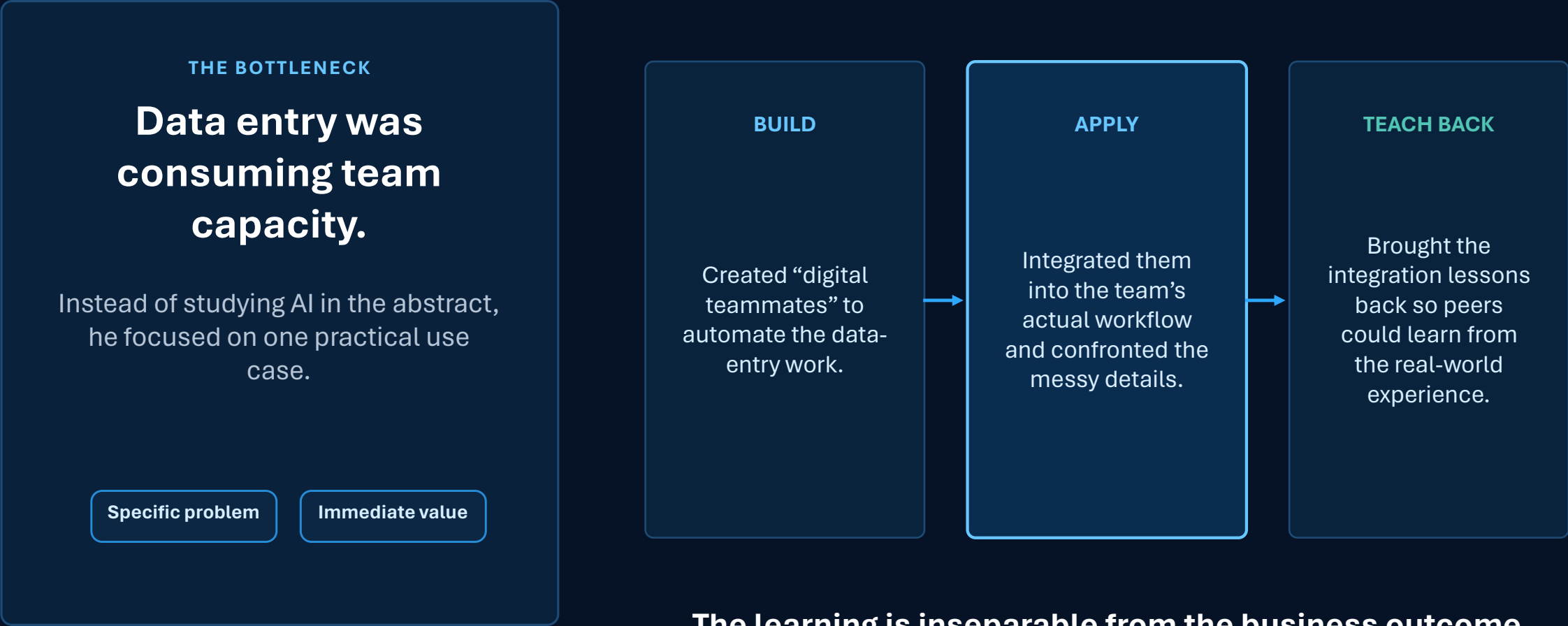
The North Star: Learn → Apply → Teach Back



A job bottleneck becomes the curriculum at the moment of need



Case example: Ken Smith at Canon



Teach back turns experience into evidence—not just anecdotes

1

FOR THE MEMBER

Explaining the work forces the member to translate tools and prompts into clear business logic. That strengthens understanding and credibility.

2

FOR THE PEERS

Peers can question assumptions, compare contexts, identify failure points, and decide what is actually reusable.

3

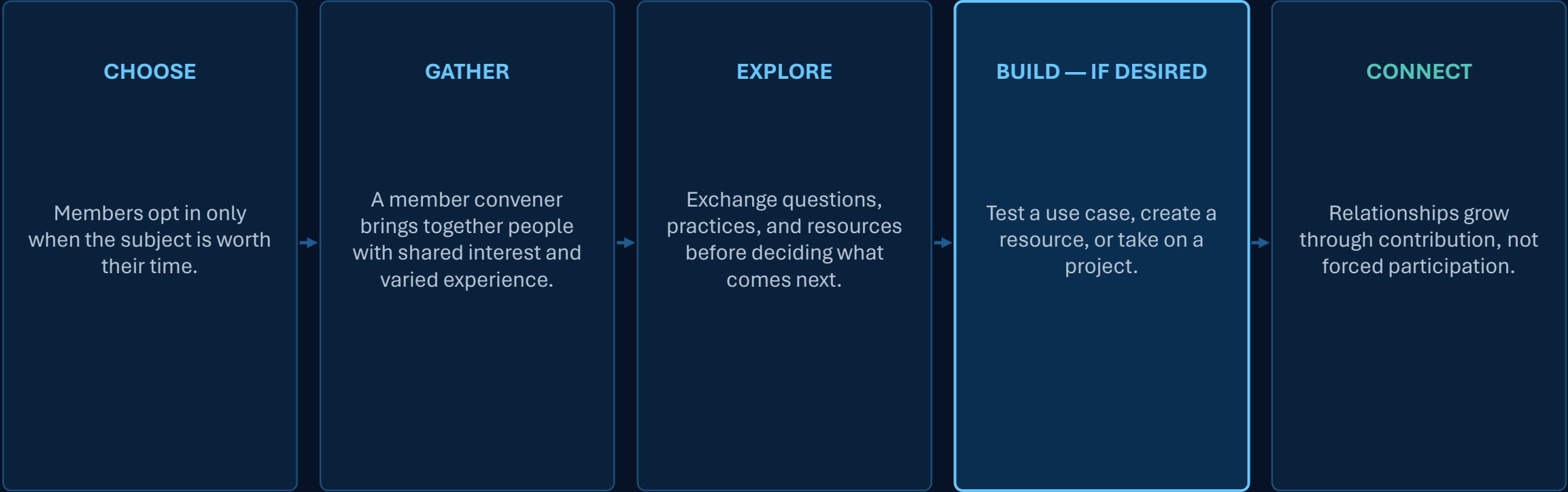
FOR AILA

Selected, validated lessons can become demonstrations, practice guides, papers, events, and eventually standards or influence.

A useful analogy: disciplined field testing—specific intervention, observed results, peer review.

SIGs give applied learning a home without making it mandatory

A SIG can stay a discussion group—or choose to build something.



Examples for an initial wave: L&D • Sales Enablement • HR • Sales

The convener owns the problem. The Board enables the system.

MEMBER CONVENER

Domain context is the qualification.

The convener does not need to be the strongest AI technologist. The convener needs to understand where the work breaks, what success looks like, and why the problem matters.

- Define purpose
- Set scope
- Invite peers
- Own the work

AILA BOARD

Govern, connect, recruit, review.

The Board protects member choice, opens doors to experts and partners, connects the right people, and reviews what produces real value.

- Open doors
- Protect choice
- Connect
- Review

Optional by design is a strength—not a compromise

High-quality collaboration comes from shared interest and willingness to contribute.

WHAT WE DO NOT BUILD

- ✗ Mandatory project tracks
- ✗ Board-managed weekly work
- ✗ One “all members” journey
- ✗ Projects chosen only for prestige

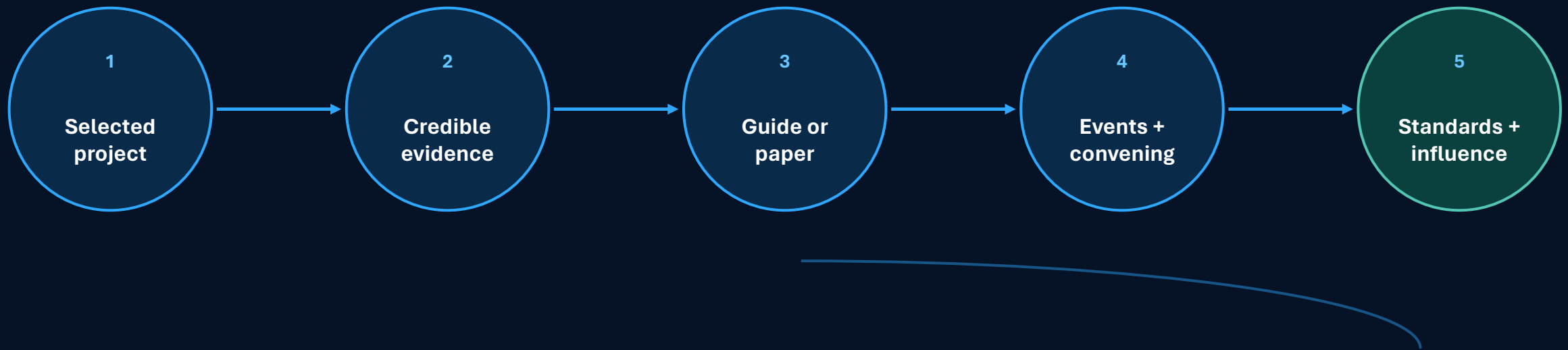
WHAT WE ENABLE

- ✓ Voluntary SIGs
- ✓ Member-convened projects
- ✓ Learning at the moment of need
- ✓ A stage for sharing when useful

The paradox: less forced participation can create more motivated, more credible work.

The best SIG work can become AILA thought leadership

Thought leadership is an output of the system—not a requirement placed on every member.



Useful publications attract members, experts, partners, and trust—feeding the next wave of participation.

A disciplined rollout: listen, add, support, expand



Start close to the work. Learn from participation before expanding the model.

The Board-level choice

We are not choosing between learning and community.

We are choosing to make learning more valuable inside a community where members can connect, apply, and optionally collaborate.

- 1 One clear member promise
- 2 Core learning + community value for every member
- 3 Optional SIGs organized around shared interests
- 4 Projects, demonstrations, and publications when SIGs choose
- 5 **A Board that governs, connects, recruits, and enables**

Board question: What specific bottleneck could a member solve today that might become a reusable AILA practice tomorrow?